Alan Karp

Director / Senior Manager, Business Operations

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SUMMARY

Business operations leader who came up through the plant floor. Since 2017: process engineering, 24/7 production management and enterprise transformation in PE-backed manufacturing. At DwyerOmega, led AI and enterprise transformation across 6 acquisitions ($800M+), consolidated 27 enterprise systems and reported to the CIO. Built wire for SpaceX at DwyerOmega, including 50,000+ UL wires. Owns the numbers: $3M+ in annualized labor savings, a 60% inventory reduction on a $20M+ base, $2M+ in automation capital delivered. Now founder of Syrup Labs AI, running AI operations with production-line discipline: every output is inspected by a check that can say no. Lean Six Sigma Green Belt. MBA, Villanova (4.0 GPA). B.S. Chemical Engineering.

STACK I BUILD AND OPERATE

Multi-vendor by design. Anthropic is one of several model and tool vendors I run; each item below is in use on my own machines.

Orchestration and agents: Claude Code, Hermes Agent (Nous Research), OpenClaw, OpenCode, n8n, MCPJungle (MCP gateway), IdeaBrowser

Models: Anthropic Claude, local models on Ollama (gemma4, qwen3, glm4, granite, llama3.1), OmniRoute and OpenRouter for routing across vendors

Memory and knowledge: Hindsight, Mnemosyne, Qdrant, Obsidian

Observability: Datadog agent on the production server

Infrastructure: Tailscale, Docker, Infisical (secrets), Cloudflare tunnels, Backblaze B2 (encrypted backups through rclone), Syncthing

Delivery: Next.js, SQLite, Playwright, GitHub and GitHub Actions on a self-hosted runner

Open source I run or extend: xxOS and Mission Control, Hermes Agent, OpenClaw, OmniRoute, MCPJungle, Qdrant, Infisical, n8n, Ollama. I write a regular LinkedIn series on AI agents and verification, built with a research loop.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Business operations: project ownership, post-merger integration, systems consolidation, process design, vendor management, executive reporting to PE and C-suite

Manufacturing and quality: Lean Six Sigma Green Belt, ISO 9001, plant startup, OSHA safety programs, 24/7 production, continuous improvement

Systems and data: SAP S/4HANA, SyteLine, QAD, Sage, QuickBooks, Workwise, MRM, AMS, Microsoft Fabric, Power BI, Tableau, SQL, Python, Salesforce, HubSpot, Jira and Confluence (Global Admin)

AI operations: agent orchestration, model evaluation, knowledge bases, n8n, Claude, Gemini, ChatGPT, OpenRouter, local models

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DwyerOmega, Chadds Ford, PA Apr 2021 to Feb 2026

PE-backed industrial manufacturer. Reported to the CIO for most of the tenure.

AI and Enterprise Transformation Manager | Jan 2024 to Feb 2026

- Led AI and enterprise transformation across 6 acquisitions ($800M+), integrating ERP/MRP (SAP S/4HANA, SyteLine, QAD) and consolidating 27 enterprise systems.
- Presented AI and transformation recommendations directly to PE stakeholders and C-suite leadership.
- Built a knowledge base over historical ticket data that cut lookup time from 40 minutes to under 4 seconds.
- Led the global rollout of one ticketing system across IT, EHS, facilities and manufacturing, four functions that had never shared one. Adoption lagged after launch, so retrained users and moved them to the single front door.
- Owned the DO52 report, the company-wide dashboard. Global Admin for Jira and Confluence. Directed a 15 to 20 resource offshore vendor team.
- Led greenfield implementation planning for enterprise AMS and Microsoft Fabric. Owned every project under a $1M threshold end to end.

Senior Automation Engineer | Apr 2021 to Jan 2024

- Built wire products for SpaceX, including 50,000+ UL wires.
- Delivered $2M+ in automation and robotics capital projects.
- Reduced on-hand inventory by more than 60% across a $20M+ inventory base.

- Received 3 consecutive Top Performer of the Year awards.

Syrup Labs AI (syrp.ai), Chadds Ford, PA Feb 2026 to Present
Founder, AI Automation Consultant. Pre-revenue AI enablement company; first paying clients are the target.

- Run AI operations like a production line with inspection built in. Built a signed-contract task executor where a second, independent model performs the acceptance check and writes a receipt (4 receipts, 3 passed).
- Audited my own research-grading pipeline, found the judge was returning a passing template and truncating 36% of its input, and closed the pipeline rather than ship it.
- Operate a self-hosted stack of 5 containerized services continuously since June 2026 at $26 per month. Verified disaster recovery for 841 GB: encrypted backup with a SHA-256 check, two verified snapshots, completed cold restore.
- Built and operate Mission Control, an agent operations platform (Next.js, SQLite) run with a fleet of AI agents across three machines. See Selected Technical Projects.

Copperweld (formerly Seminole Wire and Cable), Pennsauken, NJ Nov 2020 to Apr 2021
Production Manager

- Managed 40+ employees across 14+ production lines in a 24/7 facility; contributed to $3M+ in annualized labor savings.
- Role ended due to facility closure following corporate reorganization.

Selit North America, Inc. (formerly SSF Production), Plattsburgh, NY Oct 2018 to Nov 2020
Process and Manufacturing Engineer

- Led startup of a $20M greenfield sister facility near Atlanta, GA.
- Technical lead for a 30+ FTE production team; contributor to OSHA SHARP certification.

Toray Plastics, Front Royal, VA May 2017 to May 2018
Process Engineer

- Increased line speed by an average of 60 meters per hour, a $1M+ annualized revenue impact, at an OSHA Star site.

SELECTED TECHNICAL PROJECTS, 2026

Mission Control (xxOS), github.com/Syrup-Labs-AI/xxOS. Agent operations dashboard I extended and run on an open-source base: Next.js 16, SQLite, 161 API routes, 276 unit test files, 72 Playwright end-to-end specs, 14 CI workflows (counted from the repository on 2026-10-25).

- 566 pull requests merged between Aug and Oct 2026 and 260 commits under my own identities. AI agents wrote a large share of the code under my direction; the open-source base is by other authors.
- Agent orchestration across 3 machines on a Tailscale private network, with MCP servers, Infisical for secrets and Ollama for local models (git history: 37 commits on Tailscale, 35 Infisical, 18 Ollama, 126 MCP).
- Quality gates: a golden-question model exam that passes a model only at a 95% Wilson lower bound, and Stop hooks that refuse to end a session without a ledger entry per deliverable.

EDUCATION

Villanova University, MBA, Strategic Management, Analytics, AI/ML | 2023 to 2025 | GPA 4.0, Beta Gamma Sigma
University of Maryland, Baltimore County, B.S. Chemical Engineering | 2010 to 2016

CERTIFICATIONS AND TRAINING

Lean Six Sigma Green Belt (Drexel); APICS CSCP; Atlassian Agile Project Management Professional; Google Cybersecurity Professional; ISO 9001 Foundation; Value Analysis: Value Engineering (Lean Focus); OSHA ladder safety training

SAFETY, COMMUNITY AND ENTREPRENEURIAL

- Served on the safety team at every plant worked in (Toray, Selit, Copperweld, DwyerOmega).
- **Bike MS** rider for 22+ years; raised $30,000+ for MS research.
- **Little Thistle Farms**, Chadds Ford, PA, Co-Founder and Operator | 2023 to Present. About 2-acre organic heirloom farm.